

***SURRENDER/ ATMASAMARPAN* WILL TAKE PLACE ON JULY 19, ROYAL OPERA HOUSE, MUMBAI, AT 8 PM**

SURRENDER/Atmasamarpan, in Mumbai. This bold confluence of Hindustani classical music and contemporary Indian electronica features the acclaimed duo Tech Panda and Kenzani. Known for creating a genre that spans diverse sounds and decades, the duo will shine a spotlight on the traditions of the Delhi gharana for the performance.

The Delhi-based producers, who have numerous record-busting hits like 'Dilbar', 'Khoyo' and 'Indian Monsoon' to their name, are looking forward to the show. "Our performance at the Royal Opera House can be described as one where futuristic vibes of electronica meet the timeless spirits of classical Hindustani music and Sufi music. We are working with some exciting, younger classical musicians, including kathak dancers, to reimagine our music in a completely new context and shape," they say.

The performance will also include musicians such as dhrupad and khayal vocalist Arman Dehlvi and ghazal singer Vani Babbar, Suhel Saeed Khan on the sarangi, Rohit Prasanna on the flute, and kathak dancers Amrapali Bhandari and Priyanka Kapil.

Says Tanvi, "At our core, we have always celebrated the legends, the masters who define our cultural legacy. But with this showcase in Mumbai at a venue like Royal Opera House, our intent is to turn the spotlight towards emerging voices. Through this experience, we hope to become that bridge where tradition meets new talent, and the future of our cultural narrative begins to unfold." ■

—Deepali Dhingra



PAUL DAVID MARTIN

The ***'SCULPTURE ART DISTRICT'*** will come up on the stretch between the Mandi House roundabout and Kasturba Gandhi Marg



ARUN KUMAR

nan, Arun Pandit, Biman Bihari Das, Rajendra Tikku et al. Sculptures in stone, steel and bronze, along with identifying plaques and lighting, will be placed adjacent to prominent landmarks, like the National School of Drama, along this route.

The project was announced at a press conference on July 1. Its execution will be overseen by a committee headed by Harsh Vardhan Sharma, formerly the chairperson of the National Gallery of Modern Art's advisory committee. "We wanted to highlight the works of some of the brilliant sculptors who've contributed so much to Indian art," he says. "Visitors who come to Delhi for the first time should see the city as a cultural hub and also get to know more about our artistic traditions and history." Sharma also mentions that the NDMC wants to finish the installation of the first batch of sculptures by the end of this year.

According to K.S. Radhakrishnan, one of the sculptors contributing to the project, public art can be transformative. "In the past, some of my sculptures have been installed as public art in Bengal, Kerala and even Delhi itself," he says. "Often, people who have seen the sculptures have told me about an aspect of the work even I did not recognize previously. So, as an artist, I am grateful my work can reach the public directly." The first phase of installation for the proposed sculpture district is expected to commence within the next three months. ■

—Aditya Mani Jha